



Chloe Cho <ccho@science-corps.org>

New Science Corps Fellow Application: Anjali Mahilkar

1 message

Science Corps Web <eduversumdev@gmail.com>

Thu, Jan 28, 2021 at 1:21 AM

To: fellows@science-corps.org

Name

Anjali Mahilkar

Gender

Female

Nationality

Indian

Emailanjali.mahilkar@gmail.com**When did or will you finish your PhD?**

December 2021

City, state, and country of residence

Mumbai, Maharashtra, India

University education

PhD | Chemical Engineering | Indian Institute of Technology Bombay | December 2021
M. Tech | Biological Sciences and Bioengineering | Indian Institute of Technology Kanpur | June 2015
B. Tech | Biotechnology | National Institute of Technology Raipur | June 2012

What are your reasons for applying to be a Science Corps Fellow? (max. 200 words)

I am passionate about communicating science. As a Science Corps Fellow, I would like to enable young minds, particularly women and girls, explore the wonderful world of biology. I aim to do this via design and conduct of simple experiments that can not only help answer questions about the workings of natural phenomenon, but also expose young minds to beauty and complexity in these systems. Through my passion for science and communication, I believe that I will do this task very well.

Being a Science Corps Fellow will provide me an opportunity to grow as an individual, both personally and professionally. Via Interactions with other Science Corps Fellows, I seek to understand the challenges, solutions, and opportunities in STEM education from other parts of the world. I am curious about learning from these experiences, and molding them into use in a context relevant to India.

My professional journey has, so far, been linear, and being a Science Corps Fellow provides an opportunity to explore avenues about which I feel deeply passionate about but not had a chance to work in, in a formal structured environment. In this process, I aim to make a positive contribution in these dimensions.

In addition to your studies, describe any relevant experiences that have prepared you for a Science Corps fellowship (max. 200 words)

After my Master's, I joined as a faculty at a Central University. The six months I served in that position was a humbling experience, personally and professionally. In this time, I conducted courses and demonstrate biological phenomenon via simple methods. I realized that I had much to learn before I could do these jobs to a level I found satisfactory.

To address this, I joined the PhD program at IIT Bombay, where I joined a research group whose philosophy of doing science matched mine. Now, as I near graduation, I help engineering undergraduates and younger PhD students get started with their research. In this process, I learn from their questions. This engagement with engineers has been challenging and rewarding – in terms of communicating with a person who does not speak your language!

I have also been a teaching assistant for an NPTEL course on Evolution, which had registrants from a variety of educational backgrounds. Currently, I am the teaching assistant for a graduate-level course on Evolution, where my duties include leading weekly discussions, assisting writing scientific documents/summaries, and grading.

At this juncture in my career, I feel ready to take on an exciting challenge of a Science Corps Fellow.

Where do you imagine yourself professionally in the future? Check all that apply.

Academic scientist in academia
In science education
In science outreach

Expand on your selection above and describe where you imagine yourself professionally in the near (2 year) and long-term (10 year) future (max. 200 words)

I aim to pursue a career in academia leading a team working towards answering fundamental and important questions in biology. I am also passionate about enabling women to foster careers in science and engineering. Women are significantly under-represented in science and engineering, and bridging this gender gap is one of the goals towards which I will be striving to contribute as a woman in science.

Careers in science can be limited to the extent of a scientific challenge. I believe that an experience which broadens the prism in which I view the world – culturally, socially, scientifically, politically – helps me grow and understand the context of my research better. I aspire to enable part of this process via a stint in the Science Corps, following which, I aim to work as a post-doctoral researcher in a group which addresses questions that fascinate me the most in biology.

In order for me to accomplish these, I strongly feel that I must continue to expose myself to a variety of ideas, people, and places – so that my learning takes on different dimensions. It is in this context that I am excited at the possibilities that a Science Corps Fellowship offers.

CV/Resumé

[Anjali-Mahilkar_CV.pdf](#)

How did you find out about Science Corps?

EvoDir

Sent from Science Corps